

UPSC Philosophy Optional Paper 1 Simulation

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

SECTION A - Western Philosophy

Q1 (COMPULSORY)

(a) "Sensible things are those only which are immediately perceived by sense." Explain Berkeley's theory of knowledge with reference to the above statement. [10 marks]

Model answer (192 words; practice model, not official): The sentence fixes a definition, and the whole theory follows from it. For Berkeley the objects of human knowledge are ideas - imprinted on the senses, perceived by attending to the mind's own operations, or formed by memory and imagination. A "sensible thing" is by definition what is immediately perceived by sense. The word immediately is doing the work. Locke held that we perceive ideas which represent external objects, so that the object is reached mediately, by inference. Berkeley's definition removes the inference: if what is immediately perceived is an idea, and a sensible thing is what is immediately perceived, then an apple, a stone or a tree is nothing but a collection of such ideas. Two consequences follow at once. First, the "veil of perception" disappears, and with it the sceptical problem it generated. Second, since ideas cannot exist unperceived, for sensible things to be is to be perceived (Principles 3), and "absolute existence without relation to their being perceived" is unintelligible. Verdict. Berkeley's theory of knowledge is direct realism about ideas: we know the world itself, not a representation of it - though the price is that the world is not material.

(b) "The Soul of Superman is Good." Critically examine the above statement in the light of logical positivism. [10 marks]

Model answer (187 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. On the positivist criterion this sentence fails twice - once in its subject and once in its predicate - and the correct verdict is that it is cognitively meaningless rather than false. The criterion applied. A sentence carries cognitive meaning only if it is analytic or empirically verifiable. This sentence is neither. The subject-term. "The Soul of Superman" supplies no empirical criterion of application: "soul" has none in the required sense, and the bearer is fictional. On Carnap's first route to pseudo-statement status, a sentence containing such a term essentially can acquire no truth-conditions. The value-predicate. On Ayer's account in *Language, Truth and Logic* (1936) a value term adds no factual content; it evinces approval and may evoke it. The predicate is therefore expressive rather than descriptive, and it cannot supply the truth-conditions the subject-term has failed to provide. Verdict and qualification. The sentence is cognitively meaningless - not false, and not merely unproven. But the verdict is narrow: it does not show the words unintelligible, and within an explicitly stated fiction-framework a related claim, that the character is portrayed as good in the text, would be perfectly checkable.

(c) Distinguish descriptive from revisionary metaphysics, and explain why Strawson describes his own project as descriptive. [10 marks]

Model answer (189 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. Descriptive metaphysics describes the actual structure of our thought about the world; revisionary metaphysics proposes a better structure - and Strawson's project is descriptive because its conclusions are claims about the conditions of a scheme we already use. The distinction. In *Individuals: An Essay in Descriptive Metaphysics* (1959) the descriptive metaphysician maps how our concepts hang together; the revisionary metaphysician recommends replacing them. Strawson's own examples are Aristotle and Kant on the descriptive side, and Descartes, Leibniz and Berkeley on the revisionary side. The relation. The two are not simply opposed: revisionary metaphysics is at its most valuable in the service of the descriptive, because dismantling part of the actual scheme reveals what it was doing. Why Strawson's project is descriptive. His method is connective analysis: concepts are exhibited in their dependence on one another, not reduced to a privileged base of simples. His arguments are transcendental in form - from an undisputed fact about identification or ascription to its conditions - and their conclusions are therefore about our scheme. Qualification. The programme is charged with being circular or conservative, since it protects the scheme in which its conditions are stated.

(d) Distinguish between the transcendental and the transcendent in Kant, and explain why the distinction is indispensable to the Transcendental Dialectic. Discuss. [10 marks]

Model answer (200 words; practice model, not official): The distinction. Transcendental names an enquiry into the a priori conditions under which objects can be given to us. It is legitimate and unavoidable; the deduction of the categories and the unity of apperception are transcendental. Transcendent names the employment of concepts beyond all possible experience. It is illegitimate, because a category has objective sense only through its schema, and a schema is a determination of time. Why the Dialectic requires it. Reason's principle - that for every conditioned the whole series of conditions is given - is a regulative maxim directing enquiry toward systematic unity. Read constitutively, it becomes a claim about an existing unconditioned object, and the enquiry becomes transcendent. Each of the three collapses is then a specific transcendent move. The Paralogisms convert a formal condition of thought into a soul-substance. The Antinomies treat the world-series as a given whole. The Ideal hypostatizes a standard of complete determination into an existing most real being. Kant's distinctive claim. Transcendental illusion is natural and unavoidable, unlike a logical mistake that vanishes once exposed. Criticism prevents us from being deceived; it does not make the appearance disappear. Verdict. Without the distinction the Dialectic has no diagnosis - only a list of failed proofs.

(e) Establish the tenability of later Wittgenstein's motion of language as form of life. [10 marks]

Model answer (194 words; practice model, not official): A note on the wording. The printed line reads "motion"; the notion is language as a form of life. Thesis. The notion is tenable read as a claim about the enabling background of practice, and untenable read as the claim that agreement decides what is true. The anchors. 19 states that "to imagine a language means to imagine a form of life", and says it while asking whether the builders' "Slab!" is a word or a sentence - showing that a vocabulary cannot be specified apart from an activity. 23 closes its list with the clause that "the speaking of language is part of an activity, or of a form of life". The tenability test. 241 asks: does human agreement decide truth? The reply distinguishes levels - "It is what human beings say that is true and false ... That is not agreement in opinions but in form of life." 242 adds that communication requires agreement not only in definitions but in judgments: if measurement results varied wildly, we should have not inaccurate measuring but no measuring. Removing the background yields not error but the disappearance of the subject-matter - the asymmetry a relativist reading cannot use. Concession.

Q2

(a) "I never can catch myself at any time without perception, and never can observe anything but the perception." How does this statement by Hume problematize the philosophical notion of personal identity? How does Kant deal with this problem in his Critique of Pure Reason? [20 marks]

Model answer (345 words; practice model, not official): The sentence is the copy principle turned on the perceiver. If every legitimate idea traces to an impression, an idea of the self would require an impression constant and invariable through a whole life. Introspection delivers no such thing - only heat and cold, light and shade, love and hatred, pain and pleasure, succeeding one another in perpetual flux, and never the one who is finding them. Hume's conclusion follows: the self is "nothing but a bundle or collection of different perceptions" (Treatise I.iv.6). The problem this creates is threefold. First, the substantial self is dissolved, so nothing owns the experiences and no bearer survives change. Second, diachronic identity loses its ground: the unity we feel is a fiction produced by resemblance and causation, which let the imagination pass smoothly along the series and mistake an easy transition for an identical object. Third, and most damagingly, the Appendix confesses that Hume cannot state the principle that unites the perceptions: "all my hopes vanish". Having denied both a substance and any real connexion between distinct existences, he has removed every resource such a principle could use - and the Enquiry silently drops the topic altogether. Kant does not answer by restoring a soul. He accepts that no inner intuition reveals a simple substance, so the rational psychologist's argument is conceded to Hume. His move is transcendental: the "I think" must be able to accompany all my representations if they are to belong to one experience at all. The transcendental unity of apperception is therefore a formal condition of synthesising a manifold under rules - not a further item discoverable inside the bundle, and not an intuition of an enduring substance. Verdict. Kant answers the missing unity at the level of possible experience without proving an immortal self or a simple substance. The Humean may reply that a condition of description is not the discovery of a subject; Kant concedes the non-entity point and insists that rule-governed unity is presupposed by judgment. The exchange shows that the fault lay in the atomism of impressions, not in the self.

(b) "Berkeley destroys Locke's resemblance thesis but not his distinction between primary and secondary qualities." Critically examine. [15 marks]

Model answer (284 words; practice model, not official): The statement is largely correct, and stating why requires separating two theses Locke runs together. Thesis A - the explanatory distinction. Primary qualities are solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest and number: they are inseparable from body, since every fragment retains them, and they are the properties a corpuscular physics must attribute to any body. Secondary qualities are powers, grounded in primary-quality configurations, to produce sensations in us. Thesis B - the resemblance claim. Our ideas of primary qualities resemble the qualities themselves; our ideas of secondary qualities resemble nothing in the object. Berkeley attacks both. His parity argument (Principles 9-15) observes that the relativity considerations Locke accepts against secondary qualities apply equally to primary ones. But relativity does not entail mind-dependence: that a coin looks elliptical from an angle is exactly what a genuinely circular coin should produce. Thesis A therefore survives, though it must be restated as a distinction between measurable-structural and response-dependent properties rather than as a claim about what is "really in" the object. The likeness principle (8) is another matter. If an idea can be like nothing but an idea, and the alleged originals are unperceivable, then the resemblance could never be checked and the claim is empty. Thesis B falls. The available rescue is isomorphism: structural correspondence requires no qualitative likeness, as a map corresponds to terrain without being terrain-coloured - but this concedes Berkeley's point about likeness and defends something weaker. Verdict. Correct with one qualification: what survives is not Locke's distinction as he framed it, but its explanatory core. Locke's error was to make the division depend on a picture rather than on explanatory role - which is why physics retains the distinction while his version of it does not.

(c) Discuss the linguistic theory of necessary propositions and assess whether it succeeds in reconciling empiricism with the necessity of logic and mathematics. (Answer in about 250 words.) [15 marks]

Model answer (272 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. The linguistic theory reconciles empiricism with necessity by a genuine strategy rather than a concession, but the reconciliation is purchased at a price that later criticism showed to be steep. The problem. Logic and mathematics are necessary, known a priori and certain, whereas empiricism holds that all knowledge derives from experience. Kant answered by making such truths synthetic a priori; Mill by making them empirical generalisations. The positivist answer. Necessary propositions are analytic: true solely in virtue of the meanings and conventions governing their symbols. They are tautologies and give no information about the world. This yields all three properties from one source - necessary because nothing could count against them, a priori because grasping the meanings suffices, and certain because denial is self-contradiction - while the emptiness that secures them is exactly what an empiricist can afford. Why the rivals fail. Kant requires a third class the positivists deny. Mill is refuted by two observations: we do not discover " $2 + 2 = 4$ " by counting pebbles, and no experience could

refute it, since an apparent counter-instance is attributed to miscounting rather than to arithmetic. Assessment. The account must still explain why an empty discipline is indispensable to physics, and the available reply - that applicability belongs to the embedding empirical theory - is defensible rather than decisive. Quine argues in "Truth by Convention" (1936) that conventions cannot generate their consequences without presupposing logic, and in "Two Dogmas" (1951) that analyticity cannot be non-circularly defined. Verdict. The reconciliation succeeds on its own terms and fails on Quine's; it is the best empiricist account of necessity available before the category of analyticity was itself put in question.

Q3

(a) "Logical positivism failed by its own standards and changed philosophy anyway." Critically examine this assessment of the movement. (Answer in about 350 words.) [20 marks]

Model answer (340 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. Both halves of the assessment are defensible, but only if the failure is described as plural and structural rather than as defeat by a single celebrated objection. The failure, ranked. First, the strong/weak fork. Strong verification, requiring conclusive establishment by a finite observation set, excludes universal laws, the past and other minds - it convicts science. Weak verification, requiring only relevance, is so permissive that an auxiliary hypothesis readmits metaphysics. Ayer's 1946 replacement by direct and indirect verifiability was shown by Church in 1949 to admit what it was designed to exclude. Second, the protocol debate of 1932-35: Schlick's incorrigible affirmations cannot be recorded, Neurath's protocols are revisable, and Carnap's 1932 ruling that their form is a matter of choice ends foundationalism inside the Circle. Third, analyticity and holism: Quine's "Two Dogmas of Empiricism" (1951) attacks the analytic/synthetic distinction and sentence-by-sentence reductionism together. Only fourth comes self-refutation - the criterion is neither analytic nor verifiable - and it admits a serviceable reply, that the principle is a proposal or a meta-linguistic rule, whose cost is that a proposal may simply be declined. What was not a repair. Popper's falsifiability is a criterion of scientific demarcation, not of meaning, and he held metaphysics to be meaningful. The later Wittgenstein abandons any single criterion of meaning whatever, so he pressures the school without supplying its missing formulation. What changed anyway. Schlick's difference-argument (1932) survives as a heuristic of significance: philosophers who reject the criterion still ask what difference a proposed distinction is supposed to make. The demand for explicit rules rather than obscurity became a professional norm. The agenda of modern philosophy of science and language - confirmation, demarcation, holism, the status of analyticity - is the agenda of positivism's unsolved problems. And the separation of criteria of meaning, of truth and of scientific status is a permanent gain that predates none of the school's critics. Verdict. The assessment is accurate, provided "failed" names four pressures and not one, and provided "changed philosophy" names a surviving method and agenda rather than a surviving doctrine.

(b) "No statement is immune to revision." How far can this claim be sustained in the case of logic? [15 marks]

Model answer (300 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. The claim can be sustained in principle and only weakly in practice: logic is protected by entrenchment and by the cost of revision rather than by any certificate of analyticity. The claim and its source. It stands in 6 of "Two Dogmas of Empiricism" (1951) as the converse of "any statement can be held true come what may". The early essay extends revisability even to a law of logic, mentioning the proposed revision of the law of excluded middle as a means of simplifying quantum mechanics. The strongest candidate. Birkhoff and von Neumann, "The Logic of Quantum Mechanics" (Annals of Mathematics, 1936), proposed a non-distributive lattice of quantum propositions - a formal proposal. The distinct philosophical claim that logic is therefore empirically revisable, and specifically that the distributive law should be given up, is Putnam's, in "Is Logic Empirical?" (1968). The two must never be merged into "Putnam/Birkhoff". Putnam later abandoned the position. The resistance, from Quine himself. In Philosophy of Logic (1970) Quine argues that anyone who "denies" a law of logic has merely changed the subject, and he invokes the maxim of minimum mutilation. The later Quine is therefore a poor witness for the earlier Quine's boldest claim. Assessment. The objection that unrestricted revisability leaves science without a fixed point is met by the formula that no statement is revisable by nature, only by choice - and choice is disciplined by conservatism, simplicity and predictive success. But the concession is substantial: if revising logic normally costs more than any theory can pay, "revisable" does little work. Verdict. Holism is right about confirmation and overstated about revisability. The defensible position is Duhem's thesis with Quine's motivation: testing is holistic, the choice of revision is pragmatic, and logic is revisable in a sense so attenuated that little follows from it.

(c) Assess the view that Kant's phenomena-noumena distinction is an empty boundary that his own system cannot sustain. [15 marks]

Model answer (294 words; practice model, not official): The charge. Two objections combine. Hegel argues that the unknowable in-itself is an empty abstraction produced by fixing a permanent opposition between appearance and reality. Jacobi presses the affection problem: "without the assumption of things in themselves I cannot enter the system; with it I cannot remain" - for if causality is a category valid only of appearances, Kant cannot say that things in themselves cause our sensations. The reply. Kant's noumenon in the negative sense is a limiting concept (Grenzbegriff): something considered merely as not an object of our sensible intuition. Its emptiness is deliberate, since a boundary that had content would no longer be a boundary. A noumenon in the positive sense would require intellectual intuition, which Kant expressly denies we possess. The Schematism supplies the ground: a category without a schema can be thought but determines no object, which is exactly what "thinkable but not knowable" means. Against Hegel, the distinction is therefore not a knowledge-claim about a hidden object; against Jacobi, Kant's language is more careful than the objection allows - he speaks of what affects sensibility without claiming theoretical cognition of a noumenal cause. What survives the reply. The affection problem is a genuine tension, not a misreading. The two-aspect reading, on which the same objects are considered under two epistemic standpoints, reduces the pressure by making affection an aspect of one cognitive relation rather than a transaction between worlds; but the textual dispute with the two-world reading remains live. Verdict. The boundary is not empty in the pejorative sense: it does indispensable work, licensing the Principles for everything that can appear and forbidding their

extension to soul, world and God. It is, however, a boundary Kant can state more securely than he can explain - and that is the honest formulation.

Q4

(a) "Quine and Strawson criticise empiricism, but they do not criticise it together." Discuss. [20 marks]

Model answer (361 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. The statement is correct: the two attack empiricism at different levels with different tools, and the only documented exchange between them is a disagreement. Quine's level - confirmation. "Two Dogmas of Empiricism" (1951) removes two assumptions. The analytic/synthetic boundary fails because definition merely records synonymy, interchangeability *salva veritate* over-generates extensionally and requires a necessity that presupposes analyticity, and semantical rules give only "analytic-in-L". Reductionism fails because statements "face the tribunal of sense experience not individually but only as a corporate body". What replaces both is confirmation holism, and what survives is empiricism without the dogmas - sensory evidence and naturalism retained. Strawson's level - reference. Individuals (1959) argues that identification requires re-identification, that re-identification requires a single unified spatio-temporal framework, and that material bodies are its enduring, publicly observable occupants. Sense-data cannot occupy the role: they are private, momentary and non-spatial. And since P-predicates must be other-ascribed on public criteria yet self-ascribed without observation, the concept of a person is logically primitive, destroying the no-ownership alternative as well as the Cartesian one. Why this is not a joint critique. The methods are opposed. Quine is a naturalist who regiments science into canonical notation and denies any first philosophy; Strawson practises connective analysis and offers arguments that are transcendental in form. Their conclusions differ correspondingly: Quine ends with a revisable web in which no statement is immune; Strawson ends with conditions internal to a conceptual scheme that his method is not designed to revise. And the decisive evidence is textual: Grice and Strawson, "In Defence of a Dogma" (1956), defend the very distinction Quine attacked, arguing that a distinction with agreed application needs no reductive analysis. Quine's rejoinder - that ordinary intelligibility is not theoretical legitimacy - leaves a live dispute about standards of explication, not a shared programme. What may legitimately be said jointly. Empiricism failed twice over: about how theories are confirmed and about how we so much as refer. That is a problem-field, not a thesis. Verdict. Read together they pressure both empiricist confirmation atomism and sense-datum reconstruction without becoming one school; and an answer that treats them as co-authors of a single anti-empiricist doctrine misdescribes the only exchange the record contains.

(b) "No course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule." Critically examine Wittgenstein's treatment of this paradox. [15 marks]

Model answer (292 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. The paradox is a *reductio* of the picture on which grasping a rule consists in attaching an interpretation to it; its conclusion is not that rules determine nothing but that rule-following is exhibited in trained practice. How the paradox is generated. 185 imagines a pupil taught the "+2" series to 1000 who continues 1004, 1008, 1012 and protests that he went on "in the same way". Repeating the examples does not refute him; it comes natural to him to take the order as we should take "add 2 up to 1000, 4 up to 2000". Nothing already possessed - sign, examples, image, explanation - settles the matter, since each stands in the same need of application. The diagnosis. 201's second part identifies the misunderstanding "from the mere fact that in the course of our argument we give one interpretation after another; as if each one contented us at least for a moment, until we thought of yet another standing behind it." Since interpretation is glossed as substituting one expression of the rule for another, the regress is structural, and the first step was the error. The resolution. 201's third part asserts "a way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation, but which is exhibited in what we call 'obeying the rule' and 'going against it' in actual cases"; 202 adds that obeying a rule is a practice. Two misreadings. Treating the paradox as a sceptical result ignores 201's own word "misunderstanding". Treating community behaviour as the criterion reinstates the collapse of "right" into "seems right", since a practice has mistakes where a regularity has exceptions. Assessment. The ruling: philosophically valuable, since neither interpretation nor disposition fixes normativity; exegetically doubtful, since a sceptical solution is the constructive theory 128 and 133 disavow.

(c) Is Aristotle's view of nature of identity in consonance with his metaphysical view of causes as processes? Discuss giving suitable examples. [15 marks]

Model answer (286 words; practice model, not official): Identity. For Aristotle a substance is what it is through its substantial form or essence (to ti en einai). At Metaphysics VII (Z).17 substance is sought as a cause: the question "why is this matter a house?" is answered by the form. Matter supplies determinate capacities, not a second identity. Causes as processes. Causation for Aristotle is not bare succession. The four causes are four answers to "why?" about one ongoing thing, and in natural substances the formal, efficient and final causes coincide, so a cause is exhibited in a development rather than as an event preceding it. Are they consonant? Yes, and for a structural reason: the same form does both jobs. It states what the thing is and it is the actuality towards which its determinate potential moves. Example 1 - the oak. The acorn's matter has the potential for oak-form; parent and nutrition supply efficient causation; the oak-form is both what it becomes and what the growth is for. Throughout, the individual remains this developing organism. Example 2 - the sculptor's bronze. Casting is accidental change to the bronze, which persists; but the coming-to-be of a living thing is substantial generation, in which a new substantial form constitutes a new substance rather than modifying an old one. Objection and reply. Defining a process by its completed form reads the end back into the beginning and understates contingency and failed development. Aristotle can reply that a potentiality is always a capacity of this material under these conditions, not a guarantee of success - the acorn reliably tends to oak, not to certainty. Verdict: consonant, and more successfully than a static essence theory - but the consonance is purchased with internal teleology, which is the doctrine's real price.

SECTION B - Indian Philosophy

Q5 (COMPULSORY)

(a) "Buddhist epistemology is not a shortened Nyaya list." Examine this claim with reference to the two means of valid knowledge and the exclusion theory of meaning. [10 marks]

Model answer (152 words; practice model, not official): The claim is correct, and the reason is structural rather than numerical. Dignaga and Dharmakirti admit two means of valid knowledge because they hold that the number of means is fixed by the number of object-types. There are exactly two: the unique particular (svalaksana), which is momentary, causally efficient and ineffable, grasped by non-conceptual perception; and the constructed general character (samanyalaksana), grasped by inference. Comparison, postulation, non-apprehension and testimony are reduced to these, not omitted from a list. The exclusion theory (apoha) confirms the point. Since only unique particulars are ultimately real, a general term cannot denote a real universal; "cow" functions as "not-non-cow", generality being constructed negatively upon shared causal capacity. Both theses follow from momentariness and no-self, which is also why the instrument of knowledge is held to be non-different from its result. A shortened Nyaya list would still contain an enduring knower and real universals; Buddhist epistemology contains neither.

(b) Delineate the main points of difference between the theory of intrinsic validation (svatah pramanyavada) and theory of extrinsic validation (paratah pramanyavada) in classical Indian philosophy. [10 marks]

Model answer (200 words; practice model, not official): The two theories divide on four cells, not one. Intrinsic validation, held by Mimamsa, treats both the origin (utpatti) and the ascertainment (jnapti) of validity as intrinsic: the conditions that generate a cognition generate its validity, and the cognition presents itself as trustworthy unaided. Invalidity, by contrast, is extrinsic in both respects, arising from a defect (dosa) and becoming known through a defeater (badhaka), contradiction or practical failure. Extrinsic validation, held by Nyaya, treats both the origin and the ascertainment of validity as extrinsic relative to the mere occurrence of the cognition. The points of difference follow. First, burden of proof: Mimamsa places it on the challenger, Nyaya on the cognition. Second, mechanism: Nyaya certifies by successful activity (pravrtti-samarthya) or confirming perception (samvadi-pratyaksa), while Mimamsa denies that later success can generate validity. Third, regress: a validating cognition would itself need validation, producing anavastha. Fourth, the decisive distinction: validity itself versus our ascertainment of it. Placed more widely, Samkhya is presented as intrinsic on both counts, and Buddhist epistemology as the mirror-image, extrinsic validity with intrinsic invalidity - which Mimamsa rejects, since illusion does not announce itself as illusion. The essential qualification is that intrinsic validity is defeasible default warrant, not infallibility.

(c) "In Visistadvaita philosophy, the relationship between God and the world is parallel to that between an individual self and its body." Critically discuss. [10 marks]

Model answer (180 words; practice model, not official): The statement is accurate as far as it goes. In Ramanuja's system selves (cit) and matter (acit) constitute ultimate reality's body (sarira), while ultimate reality is their indwelling soul (saririn). Bodyhood is defined by three conditions: what is entirely supported by an indwelling self, entirely controlled by it, and existing for its purposes. All three hold of the world with respect to God. Two clarifications are essential. First, "body" is functional, not physical: it means whatever is supported, controlled and used by an indwelling self, which is why conscious selves can also be called God's body. Second, the relation is inseparable dependence (aprthaksiddhi): the modes are real and distinct but cannot exist or be conceived apart from their substance - stronger than a conceptual relation, weaker than identity. Critically, the parallel is asymmetric. An ordinary self is affected, limited and pained by its body's defects; God's essential auspicious nature is untouched by the world's imperfections. The analogy therefore holds for support, control and purpose, and fails for vulnerability. Madhva presses this further: a real self cannot be another's instrument at all.

(d) Explain the difference between Samprajnata Samadhi and Asamprajnata Samadhi. [10 marks]

Model answer (185 words; practice model, not official): Absorption (samadhi) is the state in which the mind-field becomes radically unified and transparent. Patanjali distinguishes two principal forms. Object-supported absorption (samprajnata) retains a cognitive support; a subtle seed of cognition remains, and it is therefore called with-seed (sabija). Yoga-sutra 1.17 characterises it by four accompanying factors - gross deliberation (vitarka), subtle reflection (vicara), refined lucid joy (ananda) and bare I-am-ness (asmita). The separate coalescence analysis of Yoga-sutra 1.42-1.44 further classifies object-absorption as savitarka and nirvitarka for gross objects and savicara and nirvicara for subtle objects; these two grids must not be conflated. Supra-cognitive absorption (asamprajnata) is defined at Yoga-sutra 1.18 as preceded by the practice of the idea of cessation and as having impression-residue (samskara-sesa). No object stands forth as support; the modifications have ceased, yet latent impressions may remain. The difference is therefore twofold: presence or absence of an object-support, and the reduction of mental activity to a bare residue. A further condition follows: when even that residue is restrained, absorption becomes seedless (nirbija, Yoga-sutra 1.51). Supra-cognitive absorption is not sleep, which is itself one of the five modifications.

(e) Distinguish between many-sidedness (anekantavada), standpoint theory (nayavada) and conditional predication (syadvada). Why is the order of derivation philosophically significant? [10 marks]

Model answer (163 words; practice model, not official): The three doctrines occupy different levels and are derived in a fixed order. Many-sidedness is metaphysical: the real object is ananta-dharmatmakam vastu, constituted by innumerable aspects, so no single unqualified proposition exhausts it. Standpoint theory is epistemic: because finite cognition is partial, every ordinary judgement expresses a naya, one legitimate perspective among many; a standpoint that denies the rest becomes its perversion. Conditional predication is logical-linguistic: assertion must carry syat, stating the respect in which it holds, and the sevenfold predication is its

formal schema. The order matters for two reasons. First, it makes the logic non-arbitrary. If many-sidedness came last, the syat operator would look like a debating trick; derived first, it makes qualification obligatory. Second, it protects realism. The aspects are in the object; only access is partial. Reversing the order would make Jainism a theory about language or attitude rather than about the world. Hence a script that names the three terms but not their levels has recited without explaining.

Q6

(a) "Ignorance of dependent origination is suffering while its knowledge is cessation of suffering." Present an account of Buddhist soteriology in the light of above statement. [20 marks]

Model answer (376 words; practice model, not official): The quoted statement is not an epistemic slogan but a causal thesis: misreading how things exist is itself the engine of suffering, and correcting the misreading dismantles it. Why ignorance is productive. Ignorance (avidya) is not blankness. It is the active misconstrual of conditioned processes as stable possessions - treating what is dependently arisen as though it had intrinsic nature and belonged to an owner. That misconstrual generates appropriation: what is taken as "mine" is defended, pursued and mourned. This is why ignorance heads the twelve links (dvadasa-nidana), conditioning formations, consciousness, name-and-form, the six sense-bases, contact, feeling, craving, clinging, becoming, birth, and ageing-and-death. Where the chain can be cut. Feeling (vedana) arises unavoidably from contact; craving (trsna) does not arise unavoidably from feeling. That gap is the operative joint, and the Noble Eightfold Path (aryastangamarga) is built to work on it. Grouped under three trainings, wisdom (right view, right intention) attacks ignorance directly, ethical discipline (right speech, action, livelihood) removes the conduct that continually renews craving, and meditative discipline (right effort, mindfulness, concentration) stabilises the attention in which feeling is prevented from hardening into demand. Why cessation follows. The reverse order (pratiloma) of the chain states that with the cessation of ignorance, formations cease, and so on to the cessation of ageing-and-death. Cessation is therefore not an additional event to be hoped for; it is entailed by removing a condition in a dependently arisen series. This converts the third Noble Truth from an assertion into a consequence, and it is exactly what the quoted sentence claims. What liberation is. Cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvana) is the extinction of attachment, aversion and delusion. Since the self was never found, nothing is annihilated; the process of grasping simply ceases. The practitioner is the conventional person, and continuity of practice is carried by the causal series (santana), not by a soul. Critical assessment. The soteriology is unusually tight: diagnosis, cause, cessation and therapy are one argument, and the metaphysics of impermanence and no-self are entailments of the therapeutic claim rather than additions to it. Its contested point is whether knowledge alone, however transformative, can uproot deeply conditioned craving; the tradition answers by making insight inseparable from conduct and attention, which is why the path has eight factors and not one.

(b) "The doctrine of two truths is what separates emptiness from nihilism." Critically examine, with reference to the four-cornered analysis. [15 marks]

Model answer (280 words; practice model, not official): The claim is substantially correct, though it needs a supplement. The problem. The four-cornered analysis (catuskoti) sets out four alternatives - it is, it is not, it both is and is not, it neither is nor is not - and Nagarjuna denies all four. To a realist this looks like the abolition of every position, hence nihilism, and the further charge that the denial is itself a thesis, so the claim to have no thesis (pratijna) is self-refuting. The first defence is the negation type. Madhyamaka negation is non-implicative (prasajya-pratishedha) rather than implicative (paryudasa-pratishedha), and it is scoped: the four corners are denied of things taken as possessing intrinsic nature (svabhava). Denying them therefore withdraws a malformed question rather than asserting four incompatible propositions, and no fifth positive thesis is installed. Nagarjuna's supplement is that his own words are empty too, so they generate no ontological commitment; empty utterance cures empty reification as one magically created figure may counteract another (nirmitaka). The second defence is the two truths, and this is what the claim identifies. At conventional truth (samvrti-satya), persons, causation, moral consequence, compassion and the path all function; at ultimate truth (paramartha-satya), nothing possesses own-being. Conventional truth is not falsehood but the operative domain of Buddhist practice. Without it, the fourfold denial would indeed leave nothing standing. Critically, the two truths are necessary but not sufficient: the negation nuance must also be stated, or the doctrine still looks self-refuting. And whether a non-implicative negation can be sustained without covertly functioning as a thesis remains disputed, as the internal Prasangika-Svatantrika division shows. The accurate verdict is that the two truths block nihilism, while the scoped negation blocks self-refutation, and emptiness needs both.

(c) "A candidate who is never seen to be studying during the day time secures a high position in a competitive exam." How would the Bhatta Mimamsakas and the Naiyayikas explain the success of this candidate? Discuss. [15 marks]

Model answer (283 words; practice model, not official): The Bhatta Mimamsakas explain the case by postulation (arthapatti). Two facts are accepted: the candidate tops the examination, and the candidate is never seen studying by day. Examination success is incompatible with no preparation at all, so the two facts generate explanatory tension. To let both stand, some unobserved preparation must be posited, and the minimally reconciling postulate is study at night or otherwise outside observed daytime. The night-study is neither perceived here nor remembered; it is postulated because otherwise the accepted data remain inexplicable. This is postulation from perceived facts (drstarthapatti), structurally identical to the canonical case of stout Devadatta who does not eat by day. The Naiyayikas frame the same case as an inference. Wherever there is examination success there is preparation; this candidate has examination success; therefore this candidate had preparation. The reason (hetu) is success, the probandum (sadhya) is preparation, and the transition runs through a concomitance (vyapti). The Bhatta reply is that the reduction misses what actually generates the cognition. The reasoning does not begin from a sign but from a clash of accepted facts; the movement is from explanatory tension to a reconciling postulate rather than from sign to signified; and the case shows no subject-reason-probandum structure. Above all, the concomitance is slipped in too quickly: "wherever there is success there is preparation" is not independently established, and if it is claimed as known, it was abstracted from lived cases by exactly the postulating move under dispute. The

reduction is therefore circular. Discussion should end even-handedly. Nyaya's account is simpler and keeps the instrument-list short; the Bhatta account is more faithful to how the cognition actually arises, which is why Mimamsa treats explanatory necessity as epistemically basic.

Q7

(a) Does the admission of Svayamprakasavada necessarily lead to the admission of Svatahpramanyavada? Discuss after the Naiyayikas, the Mimamsakas and the Advaita Vedantins. [20 marks]

Model answer (398 words; practice model, not official): Self-luminosity (svayamprakasatva) asks whether a cognition is manifest without another cognition. Intrinsic validity (svatah-pramanya) asks whether a cognition is entitled to prima facie truth without external certification. Manifestation and truth-entitlement are distinct questions, so no entailment can be read off the definitions; it would have to be argued, and no school argues it. The Naiyayikas accept neither thesis. A cognition is known through a distinct later cognition (anuvyavasaya) of the form "I know the pot," and validity is ascertained extrinsically through successful activity (pravrtti-samarthya) or confirming perception (samvadi-pratyaksa). Nyaya is therefore not the awkward case of self-luminosity without intrinsic validity; it simply denies both. The Mimamsakas divide, and this division decides the question. Prabhakara holds that one cognition discloses knower, known and knowing together (triputi-samvit), comparing cognition to a lamp that shows itself while showing the room; he also holds intrinsic validity. Kumarila denies self-luminosity: cognition is like a painter who does not paint himself, and its occurrence is inferred from the object's acquired knownness (jnatata). Yet Kumarila is among the strongest defenders of intrinsic validity, arguing that if every cognition needed another to certify it an infinite regress (anavastha) would follow. Kumarila is therefore the decisive counterexample. A single actual case of intrinsic validity without self-luminosity refutes a claim of necessity. Nor is his combination unstable: cognition is inferred from what it leaves behind in the object, while its truth-entitlement is settled by the anti-regress argument, so the two issues are handled by different machinery. The Advaita Vedantins affirm both, but on different ground. Self-luminosity belongs to consciousness as such and not merely to cognitive episodes, while empirical cognition carries prima facie authority until sublated within a doctrine of levels of reality. Their pairing is therefore a substantive metaphysical commitment rather than a definitional consequence - which is exactly what the question's word "necessarily" is testing. The answer is accordingly negative. The two doctrines travel together in Prabhakara and in Advaita, come apart in Bhatta, and are jointly rejected by Nyaya. Two qualifications complete the discussion. First, independence is not irrelevance: a self-luminous cognition makes intrinsic validity easier to defend. Second, the standing objection that intrinsic validity cannot explain error is answered on both Mimamsa routes - Prabhakara by admitting no false cognition, Kumarila by tracing falsity to extrinsic defect and later sublation. The verdict, then, is that manifestation and truth-entitlement are two properties, not one under two names.

(b) 'The doctrine of Relativism of Jain Philosophy cannot be logically sustained without postulating 'Absolutism'.' Critically examine this view and give reasons in the favour of your answer. [15 marks]

Model answer (269 words; practice model, not official): The quoted view rests on an equivocation between two senses of "absolute". Jaina non-absolutism (anekantavada) denies one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers; it does not deny that comprehensive knowledge is possible. Once the two are separated, the alleged self-contradiction dissolves. The charge runs: the doctrine claims universal scope; universal scope appears absolute; therefore the doctrine covertly relies on what it attacks. The Jaina reply is threefold. First, the doctrine is itself asserted syat, so it obeys its own rule; reflexive qualification exhibits the discipline it teaches rather than exempting itself from it. Second, the thesis is not that all judgements are equally true but that truth is aspect-conditioned, so judgements remain gradable by whether they respect their own conditions. Third, within the system omniscience (kevala-jnana) is the internal case of complete knowledge, available when knowledge-obscurating karma is destroyed; ordinary discourse remains standpoint-bound because ordinary cognition is ksayopasamika. It should also be said that "relativism" mislabels the position. Jainism is ontologically realist: the aspects are objectively in the thing, and only finite access to them is partial. Relativism relativises truth; non-absolutism relativises exclusive claims. Critically, the reply succeeds against the charge as printed but does not leave the field untouched. The unconditioned status has been relocated rather than abolished: omniscience now carries the completeness that finite discourse is denied. A critic may say this concedes the substance of the objection at a higher level. My position is therefore qualified agreement with the Jaina: the doctrine is logically sustainable and not self-refuting, but it is not standpoint-free, and honesty requires saying that its consistency is purchased by admitting one privileged cognitive state.

(c) Explain Citta and its modifications in the philosophy of Yoga. Why does Yoga philosophy prescribe cessation of modifications of Citta? Give reasons in support of your answer. [15 marks]

Model answer (294 words; practice model, not official): The mind-field (citta) is the unified inner apparatus of determinative intellect (buddhi), ego-maker (ahamkara) and sensory mind (manas). It is a product of primordial material nature and therefore insentient (jada), yet as a working whole it is lucid-predominant and so transparent enough to take the form of objects and to mirror the conscious witness (purusa). It is the psychical instrument of experience, not the self. A modification (citta-vrtti) is any operative form the mind-field assumes. Patanjali classifies them exhaustively as five: valid cognition (pramana) through perception, inference and authoritative testimony; error (viparyaya), as in taking nacre for silver; verbal construction (vikalpa), as in "the horn of a hare"; sleep (nidra), a positive mode grounded on absence-content and evidenced by the waking report "I slept and knew nothing"; and memory (smrti), the non-loss and re-presentation of experienced content. Each may be afflicted (klista) or unafflicted (aklista). Cessation is prescribed for five connected reasons. First, the mind-field by nature takes the form of whatever it attends to. Second, the witness's consciousness is reflected in that form. Third, in the absence of discriminative knowledge the changing form is appropriated in the first person - "I know", "I suffer", "I desire", "I remember". Fourth, the stream of modifications is therefore not a symptom of bondage but its running mechanism. Fifth, restraining the stream uncovers the already-free nature of the seer, as a pool reflects the sky faithfully once its ripples settle. Two qualifications complete the answer. Restraint (nirodha) is revelatory rather than destructive: it

removes concealment, not consciousness, and does not annihilate the mind as a substance. And valid cognition is included among the modifications deliberately, because what binds the seer is not the falsity of a mental form but the fact that it is a form at all.

Q8

(a) Compare the Buddhist and Jaina responses to the problem of change and permanence, and assess which secures the reality of the world at lower philosophical cost. [20 marks]

Model answer (353 words; practice model, not official): Both are non-Vedic renouncer traditions, both deny a creator, and both must explain how a thing can change and still be spoken of as the same. Their solutions are opposites. The Jaina solution. The real (sat) possesses origination (utpada), decay (vyaya) and persistence (dhrauvya) together. Permanence belongs to substance (dravya) and change to modes (pariyaya), so the gold persists while bracelet gives way to ring. Since the real has innumerable aspects, cognition is standpoint-relative (naya) and assertion carries the operator syat, generating the sevenfold predication. Reality is many-sided (anekantavada), and the soul (jiva) is a real conscious substance obscured by action-matter. The Buddhist solution: deny the persisting substance altogether. Whatever is conditioned is impermanent, and the criterion of the real as causally efficient (sat = arthakriya-samartha) radicalises this into momentariness (ksanikavada), since a permanent entity can produce its effect neither all at once (yugapadya) nor successively (krama) without ceasing to be permanent. Apparent persistence is a causal series (santana) of sufficiently similar moments; the person is a designation on five aggregates; no soul is admitted. The costs, weighed. Jainism secures the world cheaply in ontology and expensively in logic. Nothing needs to be re-described: things really persist and really change. But predication must be permanently qualified, the schema of assertion becomes sevenfold, and the system must carry six substances, innumerable souls and material action-matter. Buddhism secures the world cheaply in logic and expensively in re-description. Assertion stays ordinary and the ontology is austere - momentary causally efficient events - but almost every ordinary notion must be relocated to conventional truth: the same thing, the same person, the rememberer, the deserver. Assessment. If "reality of the world" means the truth of ordinary claims taken at face value, Jainism secures it at lower cost, because it never demotes them. If it means an ontology free of unexplained composites and unverifiable substances, Buddhism secures it at lower cost, because it posits less. The decisive contrast is methodological: Jainism qualifies the sentence to save the world; Buddhism qualifies the world to save the sentence. The standard error must be avoided: Jainism affirms the soul emphatically, and only Buddhism denies it.

(b) How do Naiyayikas respond to Carvaka's objections against inference (anumana) and establish inference as an independent means of knowledge? Critically discuss. [15 marks]

Model answer (287 words; practice model, not official): The objection to be met. The Carvaka holds that inference (anumana) is not an independent means of valid knowledge because its indispensable universal, invariable concomitance (vyapti), cannot be established: not by perception, which surveys only finite cases; not by inference, which would need a further vyapti and so runs into circularity or regress; and not by testimony, whose own validity is unproved. The hidden limiting condition (upadhi) sharpens this, since what looked like a bare universal may all along have been conditioned - fire yields smoke only with wet fuel. The Nyaya response. The Naiyayika abandons the demand for an omniscient survey and builds vyapti instead from agreement in presence (anvaya), agreement in absence (vyatireka), the systematic elimination of suspected upadhis, and hypothetical reasoning (tarka), which shows that denying the relation makes experience incoherent. Later Nyaya adds samanyalaksana-pratyaksa, so the relation is grasped between class-characters rather than tallied instance by instance. Why inference is then independent. Independence rests on paramarsa, the mark cognised as qualified by the concomitance. That composite cognition is neither a fresh perception of fire nor a speaker's report, so inference is irreducible to perception or testimony. Critical assessment. The reply works by redefinition rather than refutation. Nyaya concedes that finite observation cannot entail an unrestricted universal and denies only the epistemological conclusion, since warrant does not require entailment. Three residues remain: tarka is not itself a means of valid knowledge; samanyalaksana-pratyaksa presupposes Nyaya realism about universals; and elimination removes only suspected conditions. Verdict: the Naiyayika defeats the strong thesis, since a universal denial of inference cannot itself be perceived and other minds are never perceived either. He does not restore certainty; he substitutes disciplined, defeasible warrant - the fallibilist position a refined Carvaka could accept.

(c) Which Samkhya proof for the existence of Prakrti actually shows that there can be only one Prakrti? Justify your answer. [15 marks]

Model answer (270 words; practice model, not official): The proof is avibhagat vaisvarupyasya - the argument from the undivided source of the diversified universe. Samkhya offers five inferences for primordial material nature. From the finitude and determinateness of things (bhedanam parimanat) it argues that the limited presupposes a subtler ground. From the uniformity running through effects (samanvayat) it argues from coordinated diversity to a common material basis. From operation due to causal power (saktitah pravrttes ca, the standard reading of Samkhyakarika 15) it argues that determinate production requires a potent source. From the distinction between cause and effect (karana-karya-vibhagat) it argues that manifest effects imply a subtler unmanifest cause. Each of these four is compatible with a plurality of material roots. Several reservoirs could each be subtler than their products, each display internal pattern, each possess productive power, and each differ in stage from its effects. None of the four takes unity as its premise, so none can deliver unity as its conclusion. The fifth argument alone does. It begins from the observation that cosmic diversity is not a heap but one interconnected whole, and reasons that a diversified yet undivided cosmos points back to an original source in which later differentiations are not yet separated. Admitting many disconnected primal materials would therefore destroy the very undividedness from which the inference proceeds. Justification, stated as a bridge: the premise of proof five is the world's undivided interconnectedness, so plurality at the root would falsify the premise and not merely complicate the conclusion. The verdict holds within Samkhya's own inferential licence; a Nyaya atomist declines it by tracing interconnectedness to

coordination among many causes rather than to a single origin.

END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS